

Art Direction II Magazine Design

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Eleonora Masi	Martina Mondì
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Dear,

The Team

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Louis Kempenich

Creative Director

Manuela Irena D’Orso

Head Visual Editor

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Editorial Strategist

Anastasia El Helou

Digital Strategist

Eleonora Masi

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Part I The Starting Point

- 00/1 The Idea
- 00/2 The Concept
- 00/3 Methodologie and Contents
- 00/4 The Manifesto

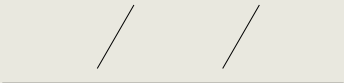
Part II The Development

- 00/5 Branding and Art Direction
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- 00/8 Digital

Part IV Results



Dear,

Part I

The Starting Point

Dear,

01 // The Idea

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with one common topic: **Migration**.

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Queer Migration

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Queer Migration

Sexual and gender identities
other than straight and
cisgender. Lesbian, gay,
bisexual, and transgender
people may all identify with
the word queer.

A person moving from one
place to another. There can
be many reasons for this
movement and many different
ways it can occur.

The movement of queer people
around the world, to escape
discrimination or ill treat-
ment due to their sexuality
and identity.

Dear,

02 // The Concept

Dear
+
Queer

Dear,

Why?

Deear, intends to explore this topic with a magazine that recalls a personal diary the object in our lives that conveys deep and personal emotional turmoil.

We aim to explore what queer people go through while migrating to find a better community for themselves, by allowing them to write “diary entries” expressing their thoughts and feelings.

Dear,

02 // The Concept

The «Diary»

The idea of implementing the diary-remenicient tone and concept is to understand someone deeper than just their physical selves allows us to. Our own thoughts and experiences are precious to each and one of us. In a diary, we are allowed to keep track of our minds in a judgement-free zone.

Respecting the issue's topic "Queer Migration" and our general umbrella category of "Queer Theory", we explore the minds of the people within the queer spectrum.

The «5 Stages»

We identified the five stages of grief as a common path that most people go through when leaving their household with hopes of a better future.

Often covering feelings of loss, those stages include

Denial

Anger

Bargaining

Depression

Acceptance

Dear,

02 // The Concept

Filling the gap

We have discovered a high-saturation of magazines around Queerness where we often see topics such as Sexual Liberation, Expression, Sex, and Educational contents, all in bright, pop and graphical designs.

We aim to fill the gap and dedicate our entire magazine to the taboo-topics of being Queer and the internal monologue of the people actively living it.

This is a safe-space.

A reflection.

A memoire.

Dear,

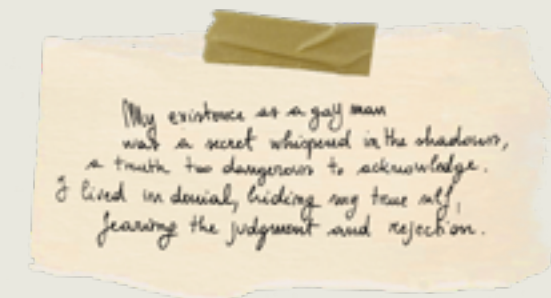
03 // The Methodology and Contents

How did we structure the interviews?

As international group, we have collected people from our homelands and surroundings that have moved out of the country, regardless of their motive.

We sent out e-mails asking them to freely express an internal monologue of "Being Queer as a Migrant" and invited them to share anything they are willing to: Songs, Pictures, Reflections, Stories, Objects, Sketches, Memories.

An open-ended collection of their minds.



03 // The Methodology and Contents

What other contents did we include?

Artists / Writers / Activists

In the course of the project, we have found out about a number of artists, activists and writers that have covered the topic of Queer Migration. We offered them a space where we share their works.

Definitions

We want to educate. The topic has way too little awareness and we want to share definitions to the reader to understand better where the importance stands from.

Blank Spaces

We let the readers breathe. Getting into the deep thoughts of people can be heavy. We want to provide time and reflection before heading into the sequential stage and offer blank pages, where readers are invited to write down their own notes.

Dear,

04 // The Manifesto

Deear Diary,

You are greater than the Bible
And the Conference of the Birds
And the Upanishads
All put together
You are more severe
Than the Scriptures
And Hammurabi's Code
More dangerous than Luther's paper
Nailed to the Cathedral door
You are sweeter
Than the Song of Songs
Mightier by far
Than the Epic of Gilgamesh
And braver
Than the Sagas of Iceland
I bow my head in gratitude
To the ones who give their lives
To keep the secret

The daily secret
Under lock and key
Deear Diary
I mean no disrespect
But you are more sublime
Than any Sacred Text
Sometimes just a list
Of my events
Is holier than the Bill of
Rights
And more intense"

– Leonard Cohen

Dear,

Part II

The Development

Dear,

05 // The Logo

Dear,



Ligatures

Inspired by French graphic designer Tristan Bartolini's typography "inclusive" Creating ligatures between letters defining a subject as masculine or feminine. **Ligatures are a symbol of inclusivity and go against binarity.**

Difficult to decipher, as our eye is not used to these symbols, we reflect on the content of our magazine. We're not dealing with things we know and are widespread enough. We unveil a sort of secret language reinforcing the intimate, anonymous and mysterious nature of a diary.

ils sont humains
elles sont humaines
i^{ll}s sont humains

Dear,
05 // The Font

Roboto Mono

Roboto Mono is a mono typeface, referring to letters written on a typewriter.

Type Designer | Christian Robertson
Date created | 2011
Foundry | Google

Roboto Mono

font-family: Roboto Mono
font-size: 32px
font-weight: Regular

Roboto Mono Bold

font-family: Roboto Mono Bold
font-size: 32px
font-weight: Regular

The Quick Brown
Fox Jumps Over
The Lazy Dog g

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz 0123456789 [] () { } / \ < > ?

05 // The Colors

Primary Colors

The classical diary: A Moleskine Journal. Black cover and yellow-tinted white pages.
Black: C 71 | M 67 | Y 66 | K 82 • White: C 8 | M 6 | Y 17 | K 0



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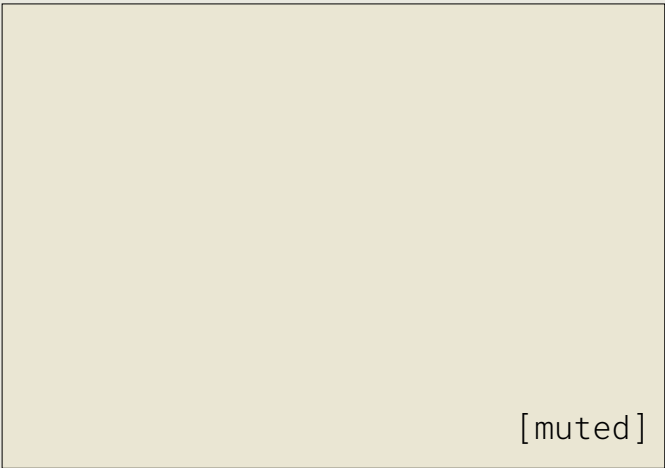
Secondary Colors

Reflecting the sequential 5 Stages and the color psychology behind those.

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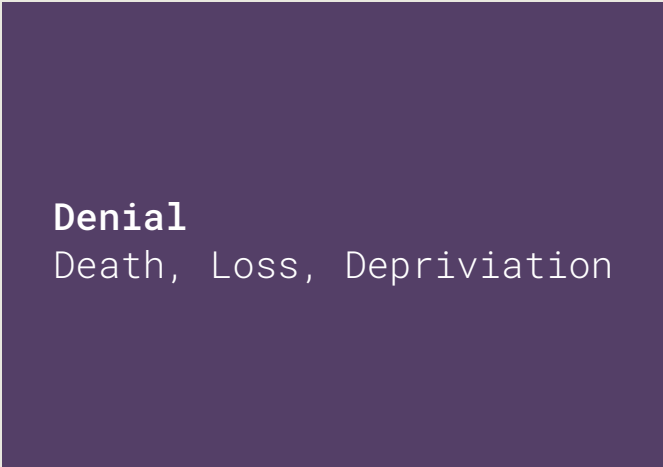
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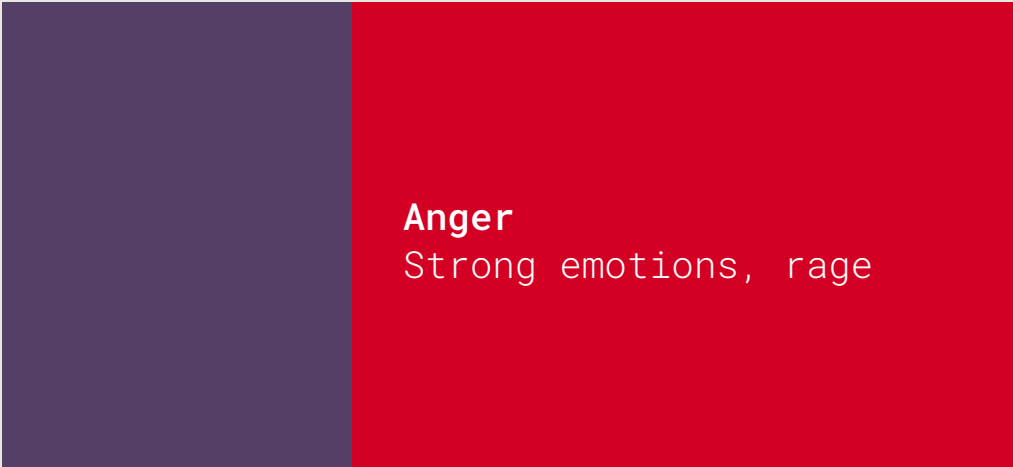
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Acceptance
patience, love, warmth

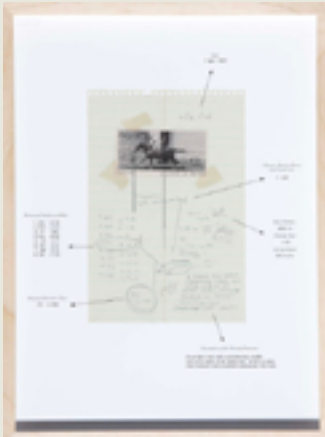
Dear,
05 // The Inspiration

Inspired by Archival Art

“The Archival Impulse” in art is making information from the past, that is often lost or forgotten, physically present again.

Archive Art is reminiscent and often based on actual happenings and collecting remainings of it. Documenting and re-shaping a collection of memories in analogue.

Reference: Archive works of The Atlas Group [Walid Raad]



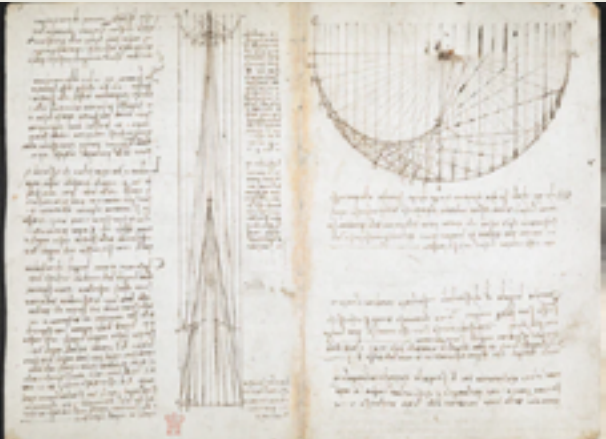
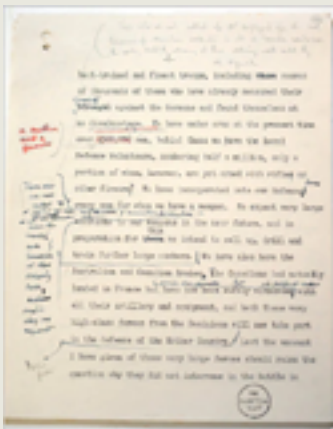
Dear,
05 // The Inspiration

Inspired by Diaries

The importance of a diary in human history is impactful for shaping all the information we have today from the past. Diaries are the window to what has been and understanding how the way humans have lived.

A diary documents parts of history that are not covered by media, or are burried along with people that carried those memories. In addition to their revelation of the diarist's personality, diaries have been of immense importance for the recording of social and political history.

Reference: The most important Diaries of History
[Anne Frank, Leonardo DaVinci, Winston Chruchill]



Moodboard



Size and Format

Custom size



Inspired by Diary's size
and yellow-toned pages

06 // Technicalities

Size and Format

Custom size

23 cm

120g

16.5 cm

Inspired by Diary’s size
and yellow-toned pages

Binding

Open Spine Binding
incl. a Link Stitch



Goal of seamlessly having the
magazine opening flat like a
literal “open book”

Size and Format

Custom size

23 cm

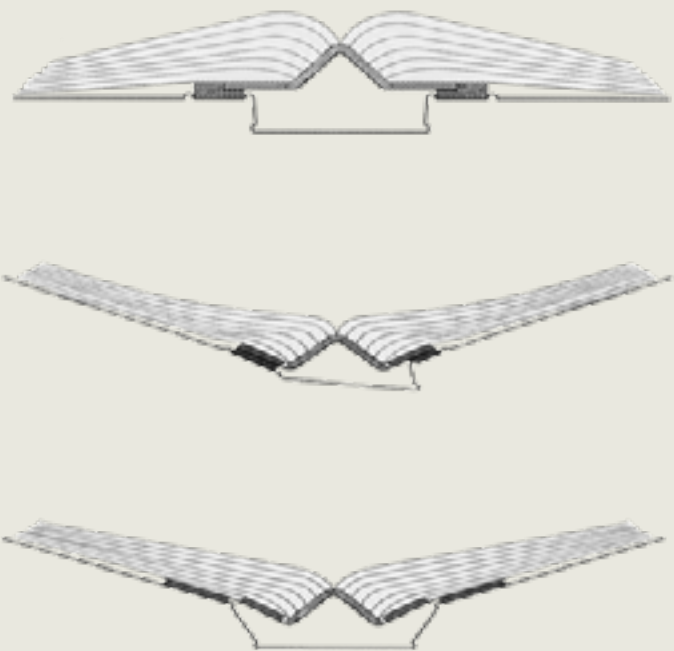
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16.5 cm

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Binding

Open Spine Binding
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Goal of seamlessly having the
magazine opening flat like a
literal “open book”

The Cover and Manuality

“Blurry” Effect “See clearly”



Magazine wrapped in tranlucuent
paper like a “Letter”

Dear,

Part III

The Strategy

Target

Everybody who is politically involved in social issues and civil rights.

- Millennial and Gen-Z focus
- Expats (people interested in internationality)
- Metropolitan areas

Launching

When?

Launch: June 2024 (Pride Month)
Relaunch: Sept 22 (Dear Diary Day)

Where?

Launch Party at LAMPO Milano -
Scalo Farini, Via Valtellina 7, MI



Distribution

- Subscriptions
- Concept stores (Libreria LGBT Antigone, Pier pour hom, Marsèll Paradise Milano, Reading Room)

TPs
Social (Instagram)
Website (Subscriptions, Newsletter: Substack)
Concept stores
Events: Community

Sponsors



- Community
- Diary / Creation
- Art and Design
- Open Minded
- (Past) Brand Magazine history

Future Issues / Magazine Continuity

01 Coming out

02 STDs

03 Trans Journey

04 Sexual Liberation

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•
•

Channels and Touchpoints Online

Instagram

- Community Building
- Diary and Archive aesthetic feed
- User generated contents
- Addressing global social issues

Digital Plan

- Launch posts (coming soon, etc..)
- Publish stories every week
- Pictures of real people and shootings
- Reels (Events and in Real life talks)
- Stories highlights (about us, stocklist, events)

Instagram Feed and Posts

Carousel Contents



Reels and ugc



Acceptance

Depression

Feed Grid



Graphics and Pictures



Bargaining

Anger

Denial



Instagram Feed and Posts

Highlights adapting to the issue



Acceptance

Depression

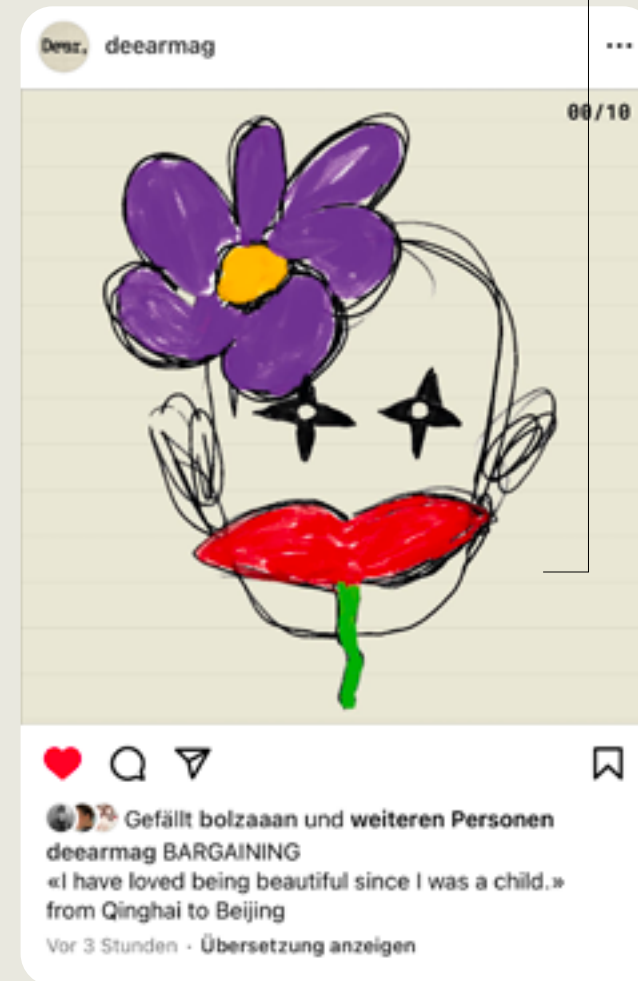
Bargaining

Anger

Denial



“Digital Magazine”
“Pinboard”



Denial



Dear,

Part IV

The Results

Dear,

41

Issue 00
Queer Migration
Dear,



Dear,

Issue 00
Queer Migration

Where do you go when you can't be home?

Dear,

Thank you very much
for your dedicated time!



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